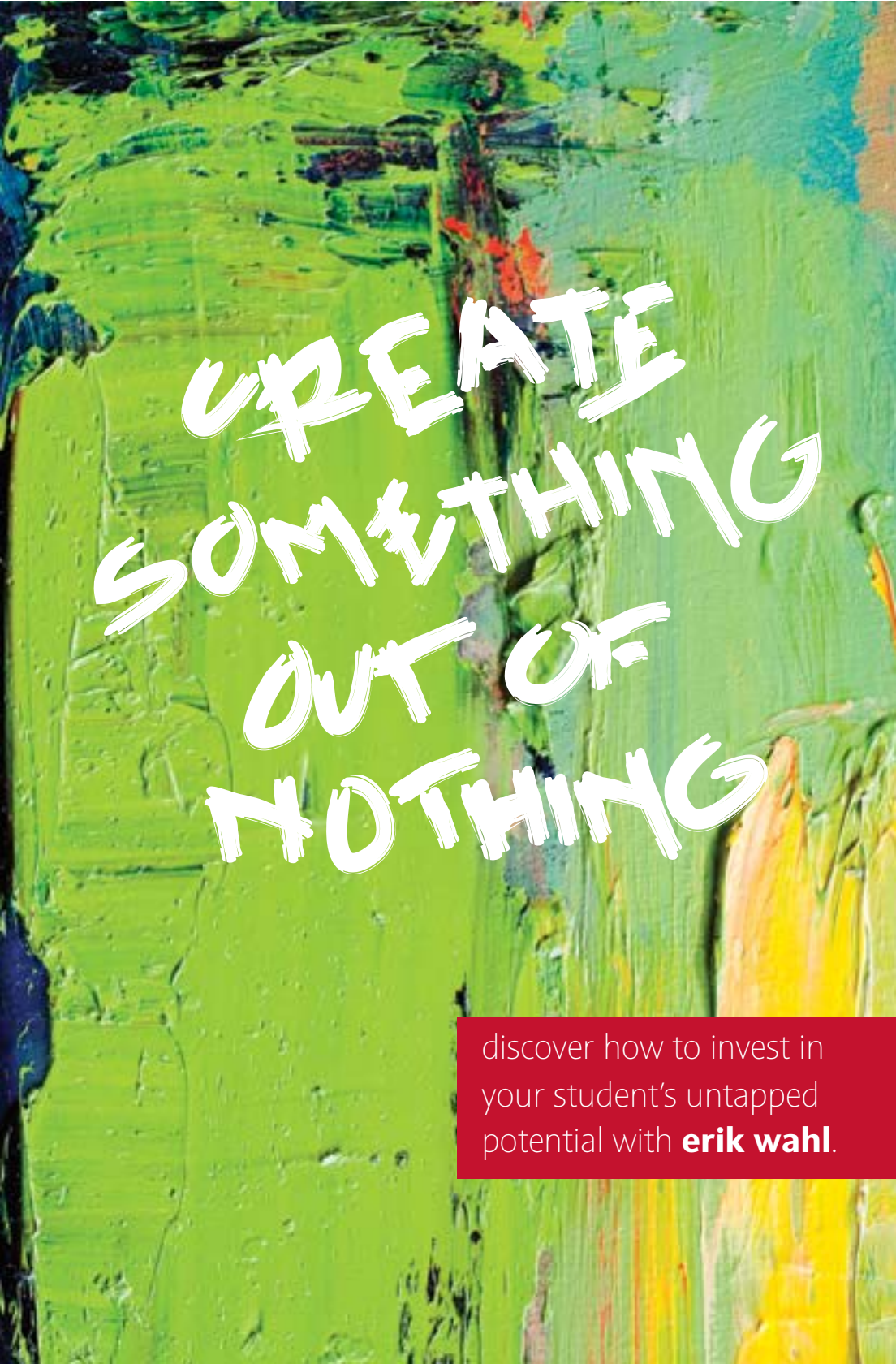
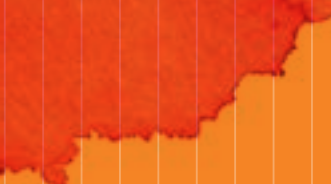




CREATE SOMETHING OUT OF NOTHING

discover how to invest in
your student's untapped
potential with **erik wahl**.



THIS WORKBOOK BELONGS TO:

(Sign with crayon)



It's inside all of us.

Hiding.

Ready to come up for air.

Just below the typical events of your daily life, a jack-in-the-box silently awaits. As the routine turning of your rusty crank continues, you wait for that moment when your Artistic jack-in-the-box can finally explode. Then, POW! Out of nowhere your extraordinary ideas and incredible concepts begin to shock everyone around you. This can be your reality! When you complete this workbook, you will discover new tools and motivations already existing all around you and be shocked to discover yourself yelling loud and proud in front of your classroom:

I am Artist!

Whether or not you have seen me perform or were handed this book by a well-meaning principal, fellow teacher, or parent, this workbook is an interactive extension of my message, in which I so firmly believe:

You are an Artist!

I realize that your current teaching "job" may not be traditionally recognized as an 'artistic form.' However, the philosophy of a true Artist lies in *the motivation with which they create*. With this workbook, you will learn to imagine, dream, engage with your students, and problem-solve with the same motivation an Artist uses to create a painting, sculpt the human form, or compose a piece of music. You are an Artist because everyday you have an opportunity to *create something out of nothing*.

Create your own path through this workbook! Take a pencil, a marker, a crayon, some paint. Play your way through it with no rules attached. Make mistakes. Make messes. Unleash that Artist buried deep down inside you! Isn't it high time you two were reacquainted? You'll be surprised what you find, because your artistic skills have always there, hidden below the surface. You simply forgot where you put them! After you discover your inner-Artist, begin to share those same lessons you learned with your students!

Accept this as a challenge you will strive to fulfill each and every day. This workbook—CREATED BY YOU—will serve as your Artistic guide to daily inspire you to step in front of your students. It is YOUR responsibility to remind them that they are Artists, too!

Dear You!

I am beyond excited that you are holding this workbook in your hands. It means you are considering participation in this wild experiment I have created specifically for you and the kids in your classroom. If you choose to complete this workbook, you will be ready to use your previous experiences and present realities to provide a bright light of hope for yourself, as well as your students. I'm positive it will work for you, because it worked for me and changed the rest of my life.

Let me tell you my story. When I was in elementary school, I always leaned on drawing to have fun or work out my frustrations. But, one day, my teacher told me I wasn't very good at drawing and should focus more on my grades. Then I can graduate at the top of my class...then get into a proper college...then have a successful career...then afford to get married and start a family. As a small boy, she stood over me and verbalized her disappointment about my love for drawing. In personal shame, I listened and put down my crayons.

And you know what? It "worked." Later in life, I had a great job. I was important. I was paid well. I knew fancy people. But that job wasn't me. I was so frustrated because somewhere along my path I believed a lie about who I was, and I'm pretty certain it started when I put down my crayons.

As a teacher, your impact on young students is eternal. The words you speak to your classrooms can serve as a watering can capable of providing life for years to come. Don't waste this incredible opportunity. Don't be that teacher that calls into question your student's hopes and dreams. We know that life will hand them so many struggles in the future. But if you served your role, they will always look back and remember you believed in them. Research shows that when adults are asked to name the best leaders in their life, they aren't CEOs, managers, or team leaders. The best leaders are those individuals who believed in their dreams; mothers, coaches, boy scout leaders, pastors, and, yes, teachers.

When you go through this workbook, feel free to make notes to recreate these experiments in your classroom. It's up to you, and only you, to know which experiences will work best with your kids. But know that when you take your students through the examples in this workbook, you will be steering them towards living their best lives.

I hope our work together will allow you to remember your artistic passions as it did for me. Don't see this as one more thing you have to do. This is not homework. This is home-play! I want you to have fun filling out these questions. Pay close attention to the emotions and memories this workbook evokes. Because it will be your job to create similar emotions for your students. When you accomplish this, I'm certain you will be living and teaching from your deepest passions and providing that attitude as an example to your students. Now, that is the true definition of an Artist.

If you never try, you'll never know.

Erik Wahl

<http://www.theartofvision.com>



Your Artist Declaration

I, _____, hereby declare myself a human being. I breathe. I sleep. I pee. I overeat on holidays. Sometimes I'm happy and other times I consider throwing items out of nearby windows. All in all, this is my life. I realize that I am the only person responsible for it and the only one who can choose to make it better.

After hearing Erik Wahl's challenge to declare myself an Artist, I have decided to become a bold and interactive participant in this workbook.

The realities I face today are the results I have created for myself. However, this reality can be changed as quickly as my own perception can. The moment I choose to see the glass half full instead of half empty is the moment I choose to take the first step toward changing my realities. As I complete this workbook, I openly allow the perception of my life to be drastically changed.

I understand that the level of fun I have while engaging with this workbook will be directly proportionate to the level of silliness I allow myself to entertain. I realize that by not participating, I am forfeiting the chance to discover new opportunities, new risks, and new rewards that were previously hidden.

I sign this document with my non-writing hand as a goodwill gesture of my newly discovered artistic thinking.

I declare that I am an Artist.

Signature: _____

(Sign with opposite hand)

Who are *you?*

**I know it's a big question, but in fact,
it's a question we rarely ask ourselves.**

Usually, people ask us what we “do.” We’re used to this question, so we’ve prepared our typical responses with culturally affirming answers. As a teacher, you might say, “I teach second grade” or “I teach drama” or “I’m a baseball coach.” These roles may be true, but, deep down, you know you are way more than any of these “jobs” you place on yourself.

Remember Leonardo DaVinci? He wasn’t content as only a painter. He was also a mathematician, botanist, astronomer, anatomist, architect, and writer (among many other things). We need to view ourselves as he did.

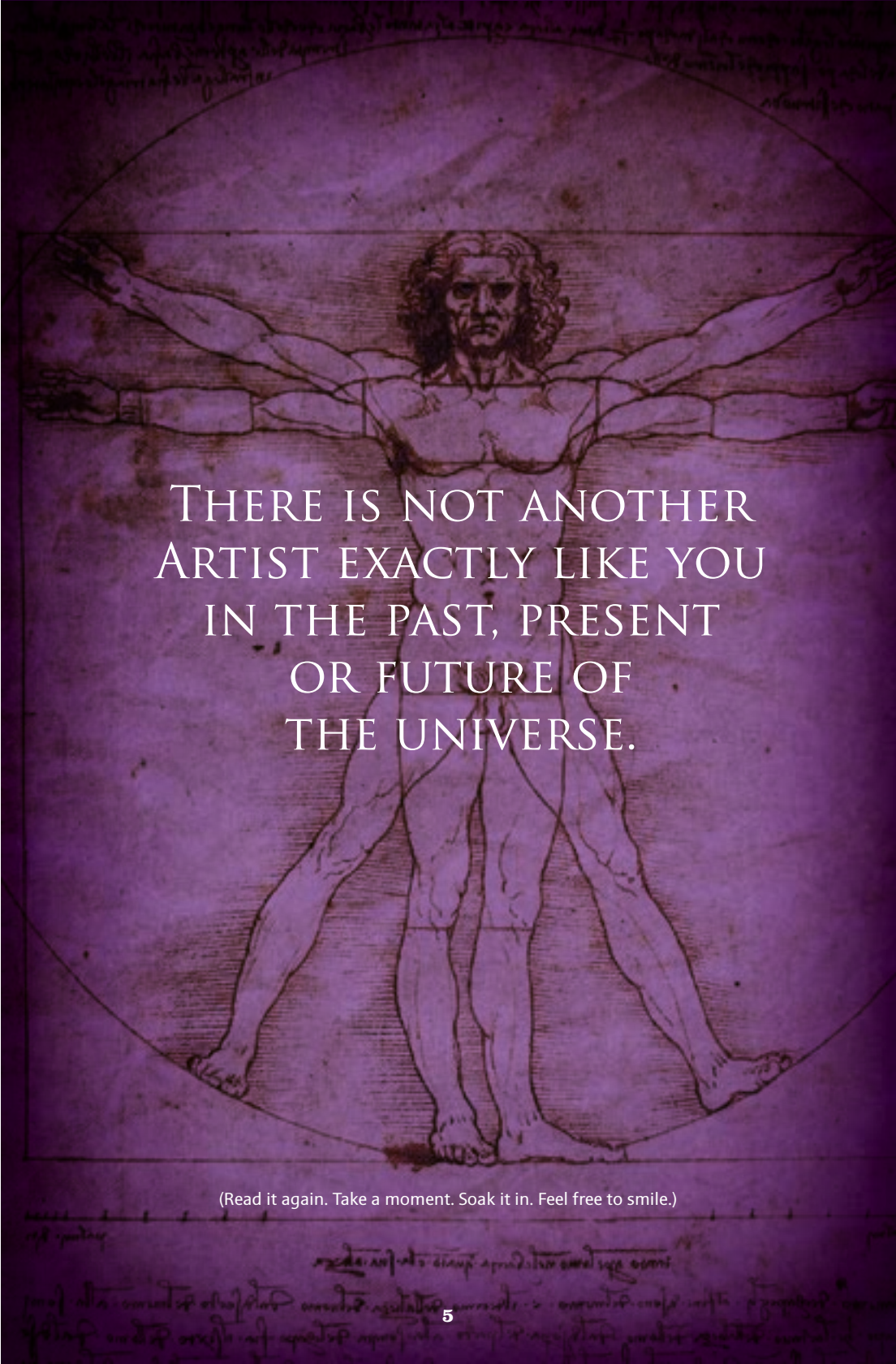
We are so many different things. We’re fathers, mothers, grandparents, sons, daughters, brothers, sisters, aunts, and uncles. We’re golfers, knitters, dog-walkers, scrapbookers, runners, and writers. We’re movie-buffs, beach-buffs, design-buffs, sports-buffs and car-buffs. We’re addicted to Facebook, reality shows, the smell of clean towels, chocolate cake and that first sip of coffee. We’re part-crazy, part-passionate, part-bored, part-hopeless romantic, part-lazy and part-dreamer.

All of your roles, blended together, form who you are as an Artist. And after considering your personality, ethnicity, childhood memories, hidden skeletons, holiday traditions, official/unofficial titles, crazy family members and social connections, it makes you a completely unique, one-of-a-kind, never-to-be-repeated-again Artist.

So, let me ask you the same question again...

Who are you?

List your artistic roles: I am a human being,



THERE IS NOT ANOTHER
ARTIST EXACTLY LIKE YOU
IN THE PAST, PRESENT
OR FUTURE OF
THE UNIVERSE.

(Read it again. Take a moment. Soak it in. Feel free to smile.)

What is *your* Art?

Congratulations. You are one of a kind.

While each of the roles you listed contribute to your artistic makeup, sometimes you have to focus on one or two because they take up so much of your time. Since I want you to make progress in this workbook, let's choose just one of these roles—a BIG one—to work on. In this case, teaching seems to be the perfect answer.

If you want to try again later with a different role, go for it. If you are participating in this workbook with a group of people, it might be a good idea to choose responsibilities you have in common so you can all discuss, argue, laugh, and (most likely) lament together.

For the rest of this workbook, this "role" of teacher will be known as your 'Art.' I want you to focus all creativity, imagination, spitball ideas, silly scribbles, and hair-brained schemes on advancing THAT form of art.

So, from this point on, the role of _____ will be called your ART.

*Artists and Relayers,
let's move forward! Onwards!*



**I
AM
ART
IST**

Mental Gymnastics

If you are going to open up and expand your mind, we need to get both sides of your brain working. We mixed up the questions to keep you on your toes. It's like muscle confusion for the brain so you get the best workout possible!

Set a timer for five minutes and see how many questions you get right!

Aaaaand go!

Watch the video!

*"Imagination is your preview
of life's coming attractions."*

— EINSTEIN

No. 3847

HUMAN BRAIN

What animal is on the front label of “ELMER’S GLUE?”

In the movie *The Christmas Story*,
what was the one gift Ralphie wanted
for Christmas? _____



What is 16 divided by 3? _____



WHAT IS THE AIR SPEED VELOCITY
OF AN UNLADEN SWALLOW?



Which original crayola crayon
package doesn't exist?
a. 64 pack
b. 96 pack
c. 100 pack
d. 120 Pack

The capital of Nebraska is
_____.



**we landed
on the moon
in the year**

_____.

What do you think Rodin's
Thinker is thinking about?



WHICH STANDS FOR
TREBLE CLEF?



OR



When you flush the toilet in
Australia, does the water evacuate
in a clockwise or counter-clockwise
direction? _____

$$214 \times 78 = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$$

The velocity of gravity is _____.

On the periodic table
of elements, the number 8
stands for the element:

HOW MANY STATES START
WITH THE LETTER **M**?

Would you rather lose your ability
to *see* or your ability to *hear*?



Who was the fourth president of the United States of America?

WHICH MUSICAL NOTES ARE THESE:



one-half of one-fourth = _____

The US state that consumes the most Spam is _____.



What are the first four words to *Jingle Bells*?

"It's the _____ of the _____ as we know it and I feel _____."

What are the three primary colors?

For answers please visit

<http://www.theartofvision.com/wp-content/>

The background of the page is a deep blue color, covered in a dense, chaotic pattern of thin, light blue scribbles. In the upper left corner, there are several darker blue, irregular shapes that resemble ink blots or abstract figures. A solid red horizontal band spans the width of the page, serving as a backdrop for the text.

Am I Really An Artist?
seriously?

Wait a second... You've done the first two exercises. Is there still a problem?

Are you still having an issue calling yourself an Artist? I get it. It's tough to declare at first, but let me see if I can help you out.

Typically, 'Traditional Artists' make things. They make movies, paint paintings, compose music, write books or sculpt rocks. These creations are what make them Artists, correct? But let's get a little more specific.

In my experience, Traditional Artists, like Monet, Hemingway, or Dylan...

1. Views life through a certain filter or worldview.
2. Expresses that worldview through their 'Art' by using a specific medium.
3. Showcases their final pieces of art to be experienced by others.
4. Allows their art to be critiqued by 'art critics.'

Welcome to Art! That's pretty much it. While some might be better than others, they ALL follow these exact same steps. And it applies to all Artists, including Shakespeare, Rodin, Picasso, or Spielberg.



Forever Young

When our brain is creatively stimulated, we start thinking like we did when we were kids. We throw away our linear logic and start thinking with reckless abandon. Remember when you were a kid and you started spinning around in circles as fast as you could? With all that mental and physical stimulation, it's almost impossible not to start laughing! I find it similar to the enjoyment of the creative process! Sometimes when I get inspired by a movie or a painting I see in a museum, I nearly start laughing out loud. The feeling of being inspired is fun!

When you were a kid, you immediately became curious about everything around you. You wanted to roll over, crawl, walk, and learn how to talk. As you grew, you annoyed your

parents by asking questions about everything under the sun. Why? Why? Why? You designed your first fashion line, invented new recipes to cook in the kitchen, wrote poems, drew pictures, and created your own games using random stuff you found in the basement. Ideas were constantly bubbling out of you!

Can you remember what you used to do as a kid? Were you a sandbox digger? Did you design submarines out of cardboard? Did you create elaborate plays with your stuffed animals? Take a few minutes, think back to your childhood, and, with no regret, start writing down the silly, embarrassing and ridiculous things you did for fun.

Just share!

When I was a kid, I...

If you need more space, use the two pages that follow.



For additional inspiration go to

<https://www.facebook.com/iamerikwahl/>



Artist or Art
critic?



Q: When did you stop doing the creative things you did when you were a kid?

A: You stopped when you realized that if you never create, you never have to risk being criticized.

We start life as an Artist, constantly creating. I imagine you see this in your classroom. When you ask your students if they are Artists, every hand in the room shoots up! But something odd happens as we grow up. Over time, we slowly turn into art critics. We don't intend to do it, but naturally, we create less and less and spend more time learning how to analyze or critique. Don't get me wrong, learning how to critique is a fantastic tool because it is a key element to becoming a better Artist. But the real problem arises when you criticize something or someone and no longer spend time creating anything yourself.

Now, here's a tough question. Do you spend more time critiquing the people and the work being done around you, or do you spend the majority of your time creating your *own* work? A big goal of this workbook is to make you feel you can answer the latter. Artists will always live amongst critics, but what sets a true Artist apart is one simple characteristic: an Artist creates.

Artist! Are you ready to continue creating?

*“There is nothing like a dream
to create the future.”*

– VICTOR HUGO

COMIC THERAPY

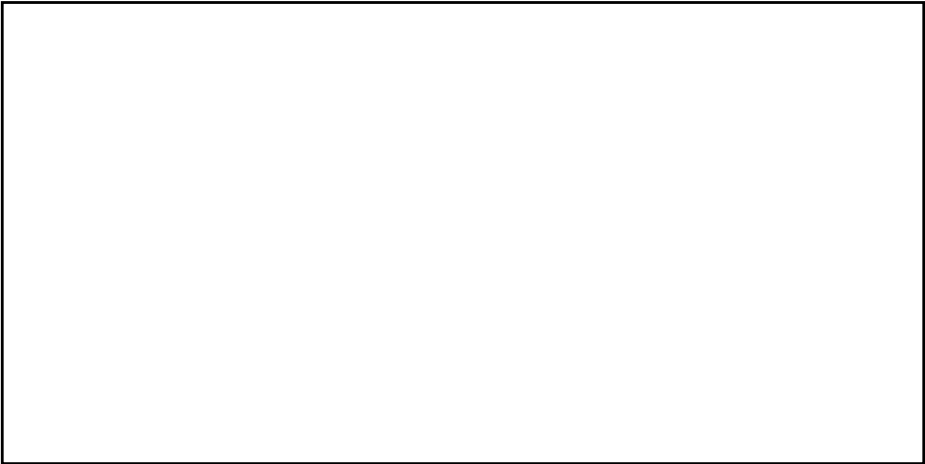
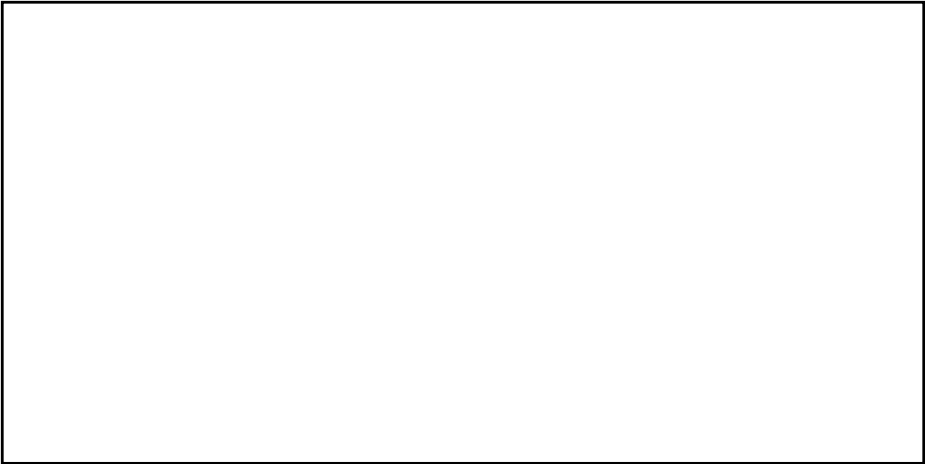
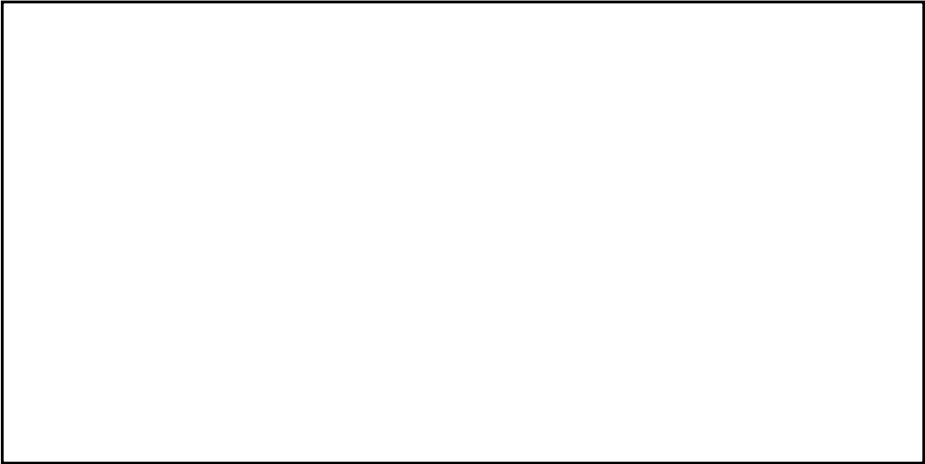
Can you time travel? I can. I do it almost every day. It usually happens when one of my senses (taste, smell, sight, hearing, feeling) brings a distant memory back to me. When I smell a Crayola crayon or feel that baseball glove on my hand or taste a freshly grilled hot dog, I go straight back in time to my childhood. Can you write down three specific childhood memories that are brought on by your senses?

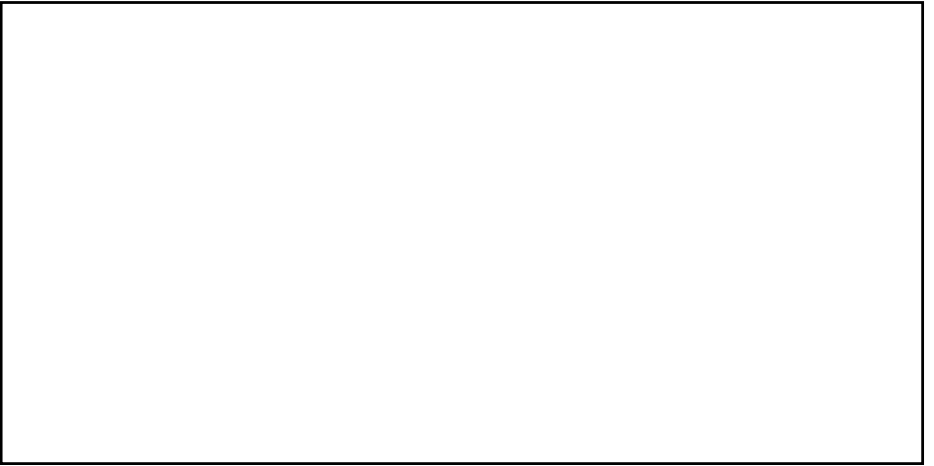
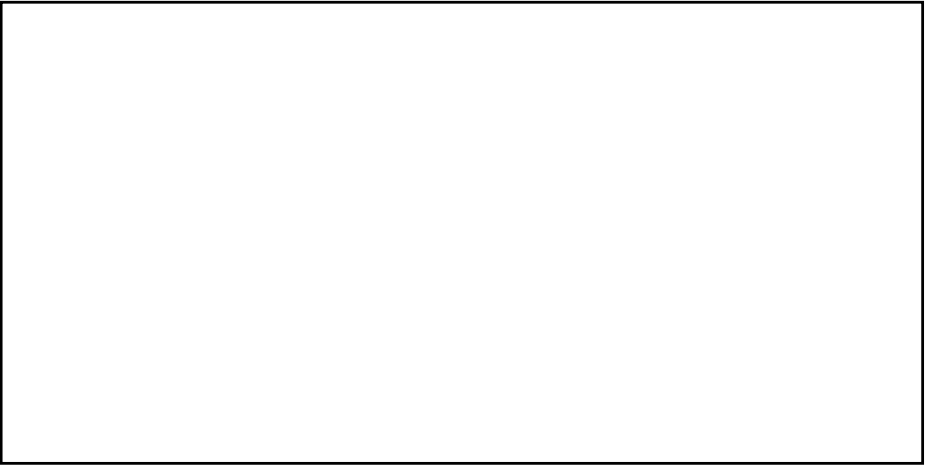
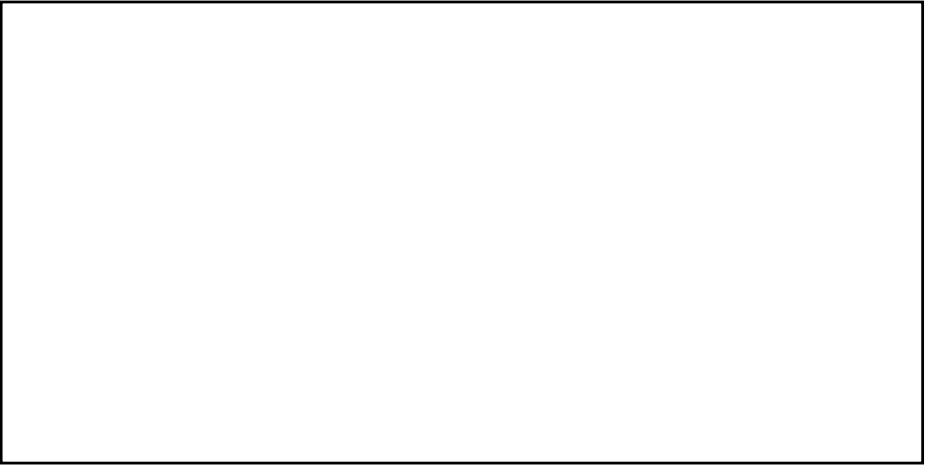
- 1 _____
- 2 _____
- 3 _____

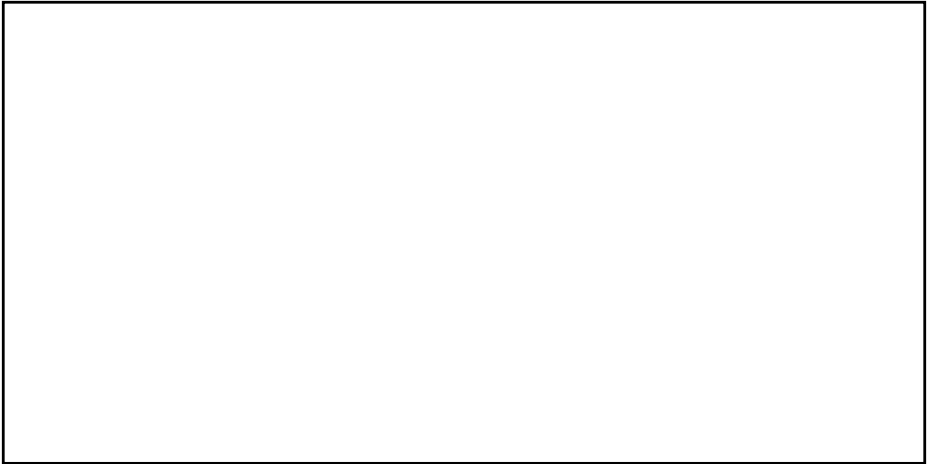
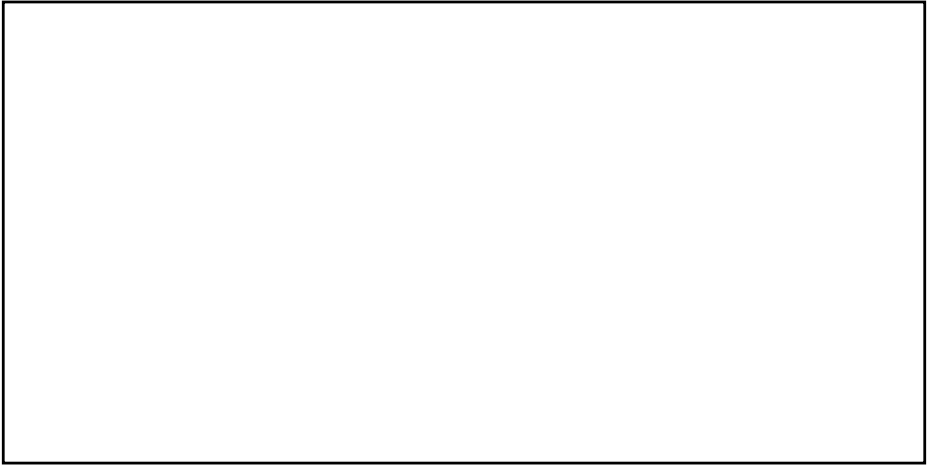
Now that you are digging through the storage boxes of your brain, you can tap into memories that shaped who you've become today. With all of the good memories, I know there are also a few bad ones. Hearing a certain word or tasting a specific vegetable can send you into a tailspin of bad memories. Maybe it was something a parent, sibling, teacher, or friend said to you that threw another pile of dirt onto the Artist being buried inside of you.

The Artist previously existing inside of you could very well have been buried by some of these bad memories. Would you be willing to close your eyes, time travel and remember a single moment—even if it's small or somewhat silly—that shaped you forever? Would you be willing to draw it in the provided comic boxes on the right? I know it may sound strange, but, if we're going to dig, we have to be willing to get some dirt under our fingernails.

Now, you don't have to get all 'graphic novel' on me. Feel free to keep it simple. And, here's the best part: After you draw the comic as it actually happened, draw it the way you would have liked to see it happen.







.....

For additional inspiration go to
<https://vimeo.com/56631000/>

Dear Me,

Our current self and Artistic self have now spent some time together talking about our childhood. We remembered the crazy things we used to do. We saw how, unfortunately, **over time we've stopped creating and started criticizing.** We even picked out a small moment in time that affected who we've become today. Maybe we feel we've lost our edge, that feeling of confidence, that competitive spirit, that drive to win.

When we think about the differences between us as a child and us as an adult, what changes have occurred inside of you?

This feels like the perfect time to write yourself a letter. Maybe you need to apologize for becoming a critic instead of a creator. Maybe you need to remember what it was like to win that big game, fish at that special pond, or bow before that standing ovation.

Take a moment and make a deep connection with who you were and feel those feelings again today. What did it smell like? Who was there? What were your dreams? What do you miss? **Is there anything you can learn from who you were at that young age?**

Dear Me,



For additional inspiration go to

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xfdCBx1ZpDk>



You are an
Artist

Since very few of us qualify as a 'Traditional Artist,' how can you become an 'Everyday Artist'?

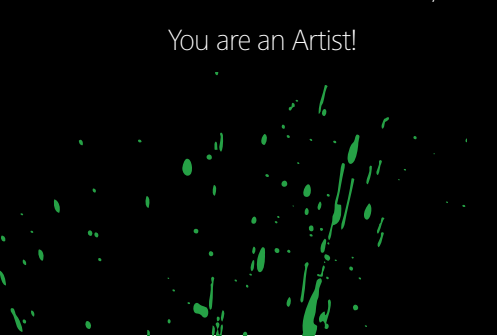
When you inserted your selected 'role' back on page four, it represented your specific Art. Now I want to show how you have gone through the EXACT SAME four-step process that Traditional Artists typically do on page eleven. I understand it may just feel different because you aren't on the big screen, featured in a national museum, or have *Entertainment Tonight* following your every move.

Every day you have the opportunity to create new things through a variety of different mediums: teaching cutting-edge materials in class, after-school activities, hobbies at home, attending an art class, taking photographs, continuing your education, or even cooking dinner for the family. Every single one of these are unique, never-to-be-seen-again creations!

Just as Traditional Artists, you see the world through your own lens, you create your specific Art, you showcase it and allow it to be critiqued by those who are experiencing your creation. It doesn't matter if your audience is comprised of students, other teachers, principals, parents, college recruiters, referees, or the school board.

I hope you can agree there is absolutely no difference between Traditional Artists and Everyday Artists. So stop immediately separating yourself from that title of 'Artist.' Quit saying you don't have a creative bone in your body. You do! Everyone does!

You are an Artist!



Haiku What You Do!

I hope you have a better idea of who you are today after spending some time understanding how your childhood affected who you've become. Now it's time you really ask yourself what you 'do.'

As I previously mentioned, when we talk about what we do, we usually make it sound super boring as a way of displaying that we haven't quite met our final goal: "Oh, I'm just a substitute teacher right now. Not what I want to do, but it pays the bills." Or we try to convince everyone else we have the coolest job ever: "Oh, I'm just a professor at Harvard. Didn't you notice the leather patches on my elbows?"

When you boil it all down, what others think about your Art doesn't matter. The only thing that matters is how you feel about your Art. I talk to a lot of people and notice the people who love their Art the most have discovered how to focus their perception on the most exciting or rewarding things about their role. Here's an example:

Hi, I'm Pat. I love my Art because I bring joy to people! I reconnect old friends and sometimes serve as a therapist between estranged family members. I love to hand-deliver gifts, flowers, and even money! Other days I hand-deliver books or clothes or antiques to people who are so excited to receive it, they often give me hugs! Oh, by the way, I love to walk around every day and work on my tan. I am a "deliverer of joy." Or, as you call it, a "mailman."

Choosing to see the best part of your role is within your reach. If your perception is similar to Postman Pat's, you will always find things about your role to love. But we also know that when you develop a bad perception regarding your role it doesn't matter how cool it may seem. If Pat's perception of his role is negative, all he is doing is delivering your bills to pay his own.

Answer a few of these questions to help you think about how to describe your 'Art.' Now, this may cause you to stretch yourselves, but that's exactly what we're doing — stretching our brains to start thinking differently.

.....

How would you describe your Art on a formal resume?

How would you explain your Art to a five-year old? What's the first question they ask, and how do you respond?

How would you describe your Art in one single word?

What is your favorite part about the creation of your Art?

If there was one element of your Art you NEVER had to do again, what would it be?

Who do you look up to that does the same type of art as you and inspires you to become better?

What does true success look like? When success arrives, whose lives will be changed and how?

If you had 25 words on your tombstone to eternally represent you and your Art, what would your parting statement be?

It's time for the Haiku Challenge! I want you to review your answers above and narrow them down into haiku poems. Do you remember how to do that? Probably not, but don't worry. I'll give you the haiku guide and even supply a few of my personal haiku poems as examples.

Haiku Guide: Haiku poems are written on three lines that don't rhyme. The first line has five syllables, the second has seven, and the final has five. Here's an example:

*I am first with five.
Then seven in the middle
Five again to end.*

Here are a few of mine:

<i>Life is my first art.</i>	<i>Not sure I agree.</i>	<i>Standing on the stage.</i>
<i>Sometimes I paint, feeling free.</i>	<i>Degrees. Pretensions. Titles.</i>	<i>Which painting shall I perform?</i>
<i>Other days I wait.</i>	<i>Don't be. Just go do.</i>	<i>Hope my fly is up.</i>

OK, you have the two following pages to try it out.

Haiku what you do!

Haiku what you do!

For additional inspiration go to

<http://www.theartofvision.com/wp-content/uploads/>

What Are Your Artistic Tools?

Now that you have a better idea of who you truly are and what you truly do, I want you to consider how you can do it in the best way possible!

When Artists work, they must always have tools to create their art. For example, U2's lead guitar player has a guitar with six strings, different sound modulators, amps and monitors. If he didn't have these things, he couldn't perform his Art! Rodin, a famous sculptor, had tools as well. He started with a giant piece of rock, and then he used a variety of chisels, hammers, and sandpaper to reveal what had been secretly hidden in the stone all along.

Everyone has tools they use to do their art—even you! But many of us don't fully appreciate our tools for what they're capable of accomplishing. I want to help you fully embrace your Artistic palette (or your superhero utility belt) full of amazing tools.

Consider this. You have email, right? Of course. This means that you have instant communication with anyone else on the planet. You have the capacity to say whatever you want to whomever you want.

That's much cooler than a rock. Am I right?

You also have computers, chalkboards, Twitter, laptops, Facebook, Youtube, cell phones, tablets, audiobooks, Wikipedia, airplanes, phone applications, and Google! When you think about all of the resources you have at your disposal and imagine them for what they really are, the idea of performing excellently at your Art should start to seem easier and easier!

Imagine your painter's palette as your superhero's utility belt containing each of your tools. Your Art isn't to talk about how cool your tools are. Your Art is to DO, to utilize those tools to create something out of nothing! Try to think about the wide variety of tools at your disposal and fashion them into your personal utility belt to create your Art to the best of your abilities.

Draw or describe your unique utility belt or painter's palette here.

Artistic Tools

For additional inspiration go to
<https://vimeo.com/56249202/>

What Goes On Your Fridge?

Do you remember when you were a kid and you would bring home a piece of work—like a painting or maybe a report card—and your parents would display it on the fridge? Maybe you even do the same thing for your kid today. This is super important, because when we put our work on display, it becomes a source of pride for us. But for some reason, we stop doing this when we become adults because many of us have forgotten how to be truly proud of ourselves.

Are you willing to comprehend and embrace the success in your life? I know that we can be pretty critical of our own work. Even when it's good, we always think, "Oh, it could have been better." How lame! If you are creating, then you have something to be proud of! Is your style of teaching going to reshape how education is distributed forever and ever?

Doubt it. Is your breakthrough theory on teaching reading techniques going to win you a Nobel Prize, or will your school play put you on Martin Scorsese's speed dial? Probably not, but they are all things you can be proud of.

Artist, it's time to put your art on the fridge. Maybe it's the name of a troublesome student you recently broke through to, or a copy of your student's before-and-after homework revealing the difference you are making. Maybe it's the name of another teacher, principal, or janitor you made smile and laugh at school. Maybe it's something sweet and unexpected one of your kids whispered in your ear.

Be honest. What are you proud of?

Write it down, clip it out, and actually put it on your fridge!



What goes on your fridge?

What goes on your fridge?

What goes on your fridge?

For additional inspiration go to

<https://www.facebook.com/iamerikwahl/photos/>

The background features a yellow field with a fine black dot pattern. Large, solid black geometric shapes, including a large upward-pointing arrow and various rectangles and triangles, are scattered across the page. A solid red rectangular box is positioned in the center, containing the title text.

Traditional and Everyday
Artists

Not only are you an Artist, but you are a 'Two-Way Artist.'

If I'm going to be honest, after really thinking about this, the only difference I can see between the 'Traditional' and 'Everyday' Artist is that many Traditional Artists don't really care what their critics or the public think about their work. They simply create for themselves. It's like they are a 'One-Way Artists' choosing to create, but never caring enough to pause and listen to the collective response.

But this isn't you. You create as a "Two-Way Artist." You actually listen to your students, their parents, your fellow teachers, and your principal. You learn what works best by hearing what the critics have to say. Then you go back to the drawing board to improve your skills so you can create once again!

Everyone who creates anything is an Artist. But those who listen to the response and improve their skills for next time are the best Two-Way Artists to have on your team.

So, for the last time, let's all say it out loud,

"I Am An Artist!"

*"You cannot depend on your eyes
when your imagination
is out of focus."*

– MARK TWAIN



Who Is Your Muse?

There is one more thing we're missing that every Artist has. This might come as a surprise to you, but every Artist has a boss. You didn't like reading that, did you? It made you imagine that stereotypical boss or principal or school board member we've all had to stomach at some point in the past. However, the Artist's boss has a different name and a very different function!

The Artist's boss is called a 'Muse.' A rough definition of a muse is an inspirational person or item that focuses the Artist's attention and helps them perform to the best of their abilities. Nearly every Traditional Artist has a muse that shows up in their creations. It may be a unique friend who becomes a character in a book or a beautiful lady who starts showing up in their paintings. Sometimes, the Artist's muse is an idea, like creating a particular response for the viewer to feel—like joy, fear, shock or sadness.

The power of a Muse is no different when it comes to you. You just need to figure out who your muse is. It could be a student, parent, writer, poet, maybe a refugee in another country you'll never meet, or your life coach. It could also be your professor, mentor, audience member, or even a mental image of yourself in a few years. If you are having trouble picking out your muse, imagine the

final person who will benefit from your Art. That's them.

When you feel like you don't have the guts to try any harder, look to your muse. They always have the ability to draw the best out of you. When you feel you can't create for yourself anymore, remember your muse, and give them what they deserve.

Each Artist's muse is their spark, their fuel, their inspiration. This muse is something that couldn't have fully existed without you offering up your unique Art form. They are a gift to your artistic motivation and your creation is a gift to them.

When a positive perception of what you love is mixed with the chase for your perfect muse, I know you have finally arrived as a happy Artist whose desire is to create.

So who is your muse? Who is the person or what is the thing that drives you through the end of a project? If you are still having trouble thinking of one, close your eyes and imagine yourself performing your Art. In the final moment, just before the project reaches success, there is an ecstatic person looking at you with a giant grin. Who is that person? They are your muse.

Describe, draw, or imagine your muse here.

My Muse

My Muse

My Muse

For additional inspiration go to

<https://www.facebook.com/iamerikwahl/photos/>

Lights, Camera, Action...

If we're being completely honest, people love going to movies because it's better than their normal, boring lives. However, I don't think this has to be the case. For example, consider your everyday reality. Sure, you may seem like a typical, mild-mannered teacher, but what's the real story? What if you realized you were the star in the middle of a plot for a crazy movie?

Are you ready for your close-up?

Let's write the plot to your crazy movie! What is the title? Which celebrity plays you? Do you have a sidekick? Do you come across a guide who shows you the way to succeed? Who is the evil villain and which celebrity plays them? In the end, how do you overcome your nemesis? Who do you save? What is your achievement? Think about your one-paragraph plot summary.

I understand that this exercise could be hard if writing isn't your Art, so don't get embarrassed if your synopsis isn't going to get you a screenwriting deal in Hollywood. If you want to try something different, you could draw your movie poster complete with the

title, movie slogan and characters. Need a little jumpstart? Here are some prompts to get you started:

My movie would be a:

- ☐ Adventure
- ☐ Comedy
- ☐ Drama
- ☐ Romance
- ☐ Other: _____

In my movie, I would take the role of a:

- ☐ Superhero
- ☐ Royal
- ☐ Astronaut
- ☐ Athlete
- ☐ Princess/Heroine
- ☐ Other: _____

My movie would be set in:

- ☐ Medieval Times
- ☐ The Future
- ☐ A Present-Day City
- ☐ An Exotic Beach
- ☐ Other: _____

Now, continue and write your own outlandish plot summary for your movie or draw your movie poster. Be ridiculous! Have some fun!

.....

In my movie, I (the star) am trying to:

.....

Need inspiration? See Erik’s movie plot at
<http://www.theartofvision.com/wp-content/uploads/>

My Movie

My Movie

For additional inspiration go to

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qQTb3E0PFek/>

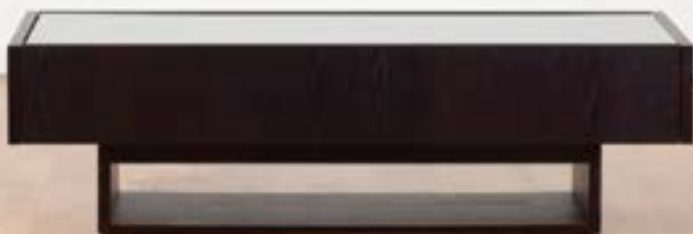
Your First Artist Statement

When an Artist puts on a show in an art gallery, they always present an 'Artist Statement' alongside their work. They come up with this statement by viewing their work from a 10,000-foot point of view. What does the art represent? What inspires it? What does it mean to the Artist?

I want to help you do the same thing by pulling all of your thoughts from this workbook together. Remember *Mad Libs*? It's the game where you fill in nouns, verbs, and adjectives to create a final crazy story before it's read back to you. Well, we're going to create our own version of that game.

I want you to be proud of the work you've created in this workbook. I want to pull all of this together to be a source of pride and inspiration you can reference every day. So, fill out the Mad Lib on the next page by finding answers you liked in this workbook and insert them into your manifesto.

Feel free to rip that page out and put it on your mirror in your bathroom, put it on your desk, or make it the desktop image of your computer. An artist needs to be constantly reminded of the big picture—not only for your Artistic roles, but for your entire life!



Mad Lib Manifesto

I am an Artist! Even though I am comprised of many roles, including...

List from 'Who are you' (p.3)

I have a unique artistic talent that I was born with. That skill allows me to become a _____

Role/Your chosen art (p.4)

Every day I set out to _____

Description of what you do from your Haiku (p.30)

driven to success by my muse _____

Your muse (p.41)

So, every morning, I select my tools of _____

Artist tools (p.33)

and do what only I am capable of accomplishing.

I am so good at my art that when I _____

List of completed goals on fridge (p.35)

I have accomplished my role to *Finish the Fight* against Cancer .

In my effort to develop into an amazing and creative teacher, I have no time for complaining or criticizing because I am too busy creating something out of nothing. Because that is what Artists do.

And...

I am Artist.

For additional inspiration go to
<https://vimeo.com/31112563/>

*I think everything in life is art. What you do,
how you dress, the way you love someone, and
how you talk. Your smile and your personality,
what you believe in, and all your dreams. The
way you drink your tea, how you decorate your
home, or party; your grocery list, the food you
make, how your writing looks, and the way
you feel. Life is art.*

SOURCE: FASHIONFEVER

For more information and inspiration, visit

<http://www.theartofvision.com>



Don't Stop Now!

Live your life as an Artist.

Today, every day.

It starts with you.

This is just the beginning...

Watch the video

